

ILLUSTRATION BY **RAJ VERMA**

Products, Haldiram Snacks Food, Dr Agarwal's Health Care, Manipal Health Enterprises and many others. Our global orientation enables us to add significant value through our extensive network, strategic expertise, and governance insights. These partnerships reflect a strong alignment to create value with strategies that are closely tied to forming a partnership of the family's legacy and operational knowledge with our strategic and financial discipline.

Beyond family-owned businesses, innovative founder-led companies are catalysing transformative pathways for India's growth. Initiatives like Digital India and Startup India have fostered a vibrant entrepreneurial community that introduces disruptive solutions addressing real-world problems at scale, serving the emerging and underserved needs of India's vast domestic market.

At Temasek, we have deployed early capital in promising start-ups and journeyed with them from pre-IPO to listing as they took on market leadership. For example, Zomato has reshaped restaurant discovery and food ordering through a platform tailored to India's diverse food-consuming landscape. Similarly, Policybazaar has enhanced insurance accessibility by simplifying complex offerings in an underpenetrated industry.

These companies demonstrated how founder-led companies can be uniquely positioned to respond to evolving consumer behaviours and demographic shifts, leverage technologies for scalability, and build new growth engines that are actively shaping India's economic future.

The deep pool of entrepreneurial talent in India, combined with a policy environment that actively

fosters innovation, has created a thriving start-up ecosystem—now the third-largest globally. India can harness its demographic dividend by leveraging artificial intelligence and exploring applications that make the digital economy more accessible to Tier-II+ consumers. The country's long runway of growing affluence and consumption spend, coupled with proliferating digital fluency, establishes structural resilience and creates compounding opportunities that attract long-term investors.

We remain excited about opportunities to partner both family-owned businesses and founder-led companies. These two engines provide great complementarity as Temasek seeks to build a resilient portfolio that delivers sustainable returns from the consumption-led growth in India, over the long term.

Over the last year, Temasek has invested over \$3 billion in India. Our India portfolio exposure now stands around \$50 billion, and we continue to see abundant opportunities ahead. Going forward, we plan to deepen our investments in consumer, financial services, and healthcare sectors, responding to growing demand from the country's rising middle-income population.

India's position in the world economy will continue to strengthen in the coming years. By providing not just capital but also global expertise and networks, we aim to play a role to help build resilient and innovative Indian enterprises, with family owners and founders, that will drive the country's next wave of growth towards 2047 and beyond. **BT**

Views are personal